

2007

IN MEMORIAM

From an ex-prime minister to doyens of industry. From a master of quirky melodies to the man who gave us *Sholay*. We bid adieu to icons who left an indelible mark on the nation's psyche.

CHANDRA SHEKHAR
[b1927]

Forever Young Turk

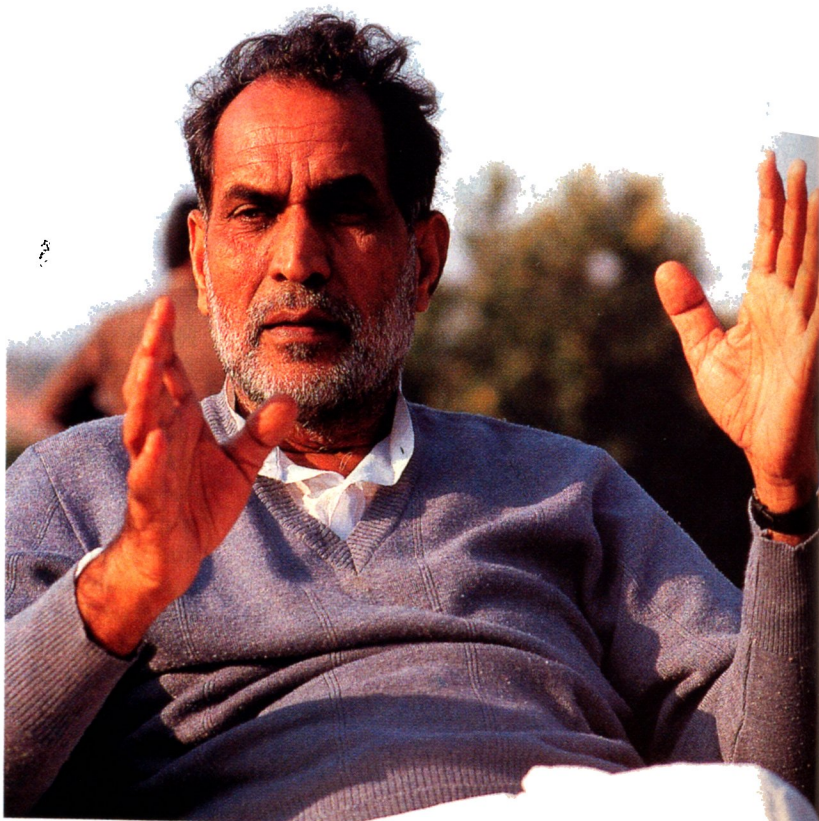
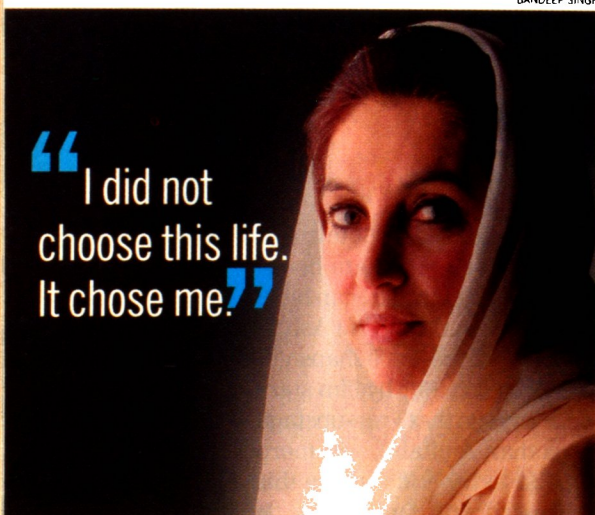
As the first president of the Janata Party, the leader-in-waiting challenged the deep-seated autocracy of Indira Gandhi's Congress. Later, he joined hands with her son Rajiv Gandhi less to realise his own ambition of becoming prime minister and more to spite V.P. Singh who had edged him out of the job a year earlier. He headed the government for a troubled seven months. The Young Turk should have remained the best prime minister that India never had.

BENAZIR BHUTTO
[b1953]

Daughter of the East

Her father was hanged and her brothers murdered. Yet, the despotism that ran through the veins of her nation only underscored the young leader's determination and popularity. She returned home after eight years in exile and died a martyr of democracy.

BANDEEP SINGH

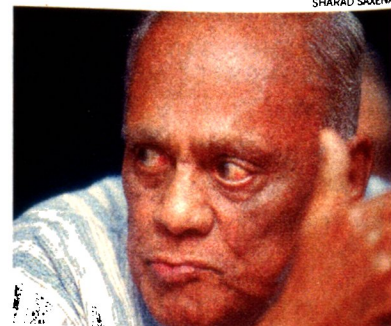


SHARAD SAXENA

JANA KRISHNAMURTHY
[b1928]

Backroom Boss

Respected for his swayamsevak ethics, he was affiliated with the Jana Sangh for so long it became his first name. Law Minister during the NDA regime, he was among the founders of the BJP and briefly, its president.



SHARAD SAXENA